Mountain View Historical Association
November, 2003 — Newsletter
Hilton U. Brown, III — Editor

A Century of Change
Growing up in Mtn View In a Japanese American Family
By Margaret Nakamura Cooper

At our May 2003 meeting, Victor Calvo told his interesting story of growing up in Mountain View in a Spanish American family. Our November 2, 2003 meeting will be the story of Margaret Nakamura Cooper growing up in Mountain View as a member of a Japanese American family. Although her life in Mountain view was interrupted by the relocation of Japanese Americans to concentration camps during World War II, she returned with her parents and brothers in 1946, graduating from Mountain View Union High School with honors. She obtained her degree and teaching credential from San Jose State College, graduating again with honors.

She married Frederick Cooper in 1953 at a ceremony in Los Altos. The couple spent a year traveling in Europe before the addition of three sons. The couple now lives in Santa Maria, California. Margaret visits the Mountain View/Los Altos area frequently since her mother and brother are longtime residents of this area. Margaret's mother, Nellie, is an active 101 year old. A book about the family entitled *A Century of Change* is available in the Mountain View and Los Altos libraries.

Come and hear a story of the growth of an individual in a family with strong values, who has led a productive life influenced by her ancestry.

President's Message

The MVHA November meeting is our Annual Meeting. Thanks to Wally Erichsen and Pat Figueroa, we now have our new MVHA brochure. It is an attractive presentation, in color, of MVHA and our *Milestones* book. Copies will be on hand at the meeting. As mentioned in the August Newsletter, the revision of the by-laws will be up for vote by the Association members at this meeting.

We are currently looking for a new location for our Association meetings. The City of Mountain View recently changed their requirements for our use of the Adobe which includes a significant fee increase. As a result, we must find a more suitable location to meet. If anyone has information that might help our search, please let us know.

Can you help? The old library card file cabinet in the History Room at the Library is full and therefore the files of 3 x 5 cards are overflowing int "the likes" of shoeboxes. So far we have been unable to find any additional old-style card files for information storage. People come to the History Room for information from the past about events, places, people and family history. Many of them leave with their quest fulfilled and likely pleased at the extent of the resources available. Thanks to our City Historian Barbara Kinchen and staff of volunteers, a significant service is being provided to the community. Pay a visit to the History Room on any Tuesday from 2 to 5pm.

Craig Holden, President

Notice to All MVHA Members

To comply with MVHA by-laws, you are hereby notified that the revised by-laws of our Association will be voted on at the November 2, 2003 meeting of MVHA. A two-thirds (2/3) majority by the members present is required to approve. The meeting will be held at the Adobe in Mountain View Beginning at 2 P.M.

Copies of the amended by-laws with a comparison to the present by-laws will be available at the November meeting.

What Happened?
Explanations and Excuses From your Editor, Hilton Brown

On the world news front, my problems may seem small, but to me, with medical problems to deal with, bills to pay, and the Newsletter to produce, they seem pretty overwhelming.

Three weeks ago, my trusty computer passed on into that great and mysterious silicon heaven. I could have mourned its passing for it has served me well, but it took all of family's medical records, financial records, and, at the moment worst of all, the templates and formatting information for the creation of the MVHA Newsletter, and worst and most tedious, the MVHA membership database. This is the database from which the mailing labels for the Newsletter are produced.

A week ago a beautiful replacement machine arrived. It's fast, user friendly (sort of) and very handsome, but doesn't know anything. My hard drives have been sent out for data recovery operations, but the information won't be available to me until some unknown future date.

By good fortune, our Membership Chair had in her possession a marked up paper printout of the database. So, I have been sitting at the keyboard entering the name and address of each of the three hundred or so people and organizations who receive the Newsletter. The task is particularly critical right now because ***Dues are Due***, and so the current status of each of our members needed to be made available.

In trying to put together a presentable Newsletter, of course none of the standard pictures are available, and even such mundane stuff as heading and body fonts, column layouts, and the "boilerplate" stuff like the list of officers, the Life Members List, etc., etc.

The net is, I'm leaving out a lot of material that I would ordinarily include. Please consider this substitute Newsletter as a sort of glorified "Meeting Notice". I intend to put together the "real" Newsletter in a few weeks, as soon has I have my act back together. In the meantime, thank you for your forbearance.

Notice — Dues are Due

Dues are now payable for the 2004. The white mailing label on the outside of your Newsletter indicates the year thru which your dues are paid. The year is the number in parenthesis, for example (2002). If the number is 2004 or higher, your dues are paid. If the number is 2003 or lower, dues are due! The code in the adjacent parenthesis indicates your membership class. (AS) is single membership, $7.00 per year. (AF) is family membership, $10.00 per year. A return envelope is for your convenience. Thank you!

In Commemoration

John K. Stoddard: Born March 9, 1922 in Mason City, Iowa. Died July 29, 2003 of multiple complications at El Camino Hospital in Mountain View. He is survived by his wife, Elizabeth "Betty"; son Eric and daughter-in-law Jewel of Danville; his daughter Elizabeth; and his son-in-law Paul Lenarcic of Mountain View. A native of Iowa, he moved to Chicago with his parents as a young child, the to Arizona, and eventually to Mountain View. Mr. Stoddard served in the Navy in World War II, then graduated from Santa Clara University. Mr. Stoddard was active in civil affairs. He was a member of the Elks Lodge, the Santa Clara Valley Navy League, served on the Mountain View Parks and Recreation Commission, was active with Little League and was a Religion Teacher at St. Joseph School. John Stoddard and his wife Betty were long time members of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Susan Mary (Lackey) Ozubko: Born May 15, 1953 to Arthur and Joy Hobbs Lackey in Deep River, Ontario, Canada. Died July 22, 2003 at Kaiser Foundation Hospital in Fontana, California. Survived by husband Gene Ozubko of Hemet, CA; her father Arthur Lackey of Canada; her daughter Rhea Bourgeois of Ottawa, Canada; her son Ryan Ozubko of San Jose CA; her brother Brian Lackey of Georgetown, Ottawa; and three grandchildren. She served as Director of Library Services for the City of Mountain View for fifteen years, and during that time oversaw the construction of the City's outstanding new 60,000 square foot new Public Library. Mrs. Ozubko was active in community affairs and enjoyed golf, quilting, reading, gardening, Cajun dancing and cooking. After she and her husband moved to Hemet, CA she became very active with the Hemet Library Foundation and played a leading role in the construction of the new Hemet Public Library, which was dedicated shortly before her death.

Eva Mockbee: Born December 8, 1920 in Vienna, Austria. Died August 11, 2003 in her Mountain View home. Ms. Mockbee immigrated with her parents to California in 1938. After graduating from Santa Barbara State College, she earned a Masters Degree from San Jose State College and did further graduate work at Mills College. She worked for the Mountain View-Los Altos Union High School District from 1943 to 1983 where she was a physical education and science teacher, dean of girls, counselor and head of the counseling department. Active in civic affairs, she was a member of the Quota Club, Business and Professional Women's Club and a Life member of the Mountain View Historical Association. She received the Woman of the year award from the BPWC, the Women of Achievement award from the Women's Forum. She spearheaded the Mountain View War Memorial Effort. Ms. Mockbee was preceded in death by her husband Bud. She is survived by a step son John Mockbee.

El Camino Hospital Bond Issue

Tuesday, November 4, 2003 is another election. The El Camino Hospital District Bond issue will be on the ballot along with the election of Governing Board Members for the Foothill-De Anza Community College District. Many local City Council and other local officials are also on the ballot. You should have received a sample Ballot from the Registrar of Voters. Read, learn and then vote!

Mountain View Historical Association
Regular Meeting

A Century of Change
Growing up in Mountain View
for a
Japanese American Family

Presented by

Margaret Nakamura Cooper

Sunday, November 2, 2003 — 2:00 P.M.

The Adobe Building — Moffett Blvd and Central Expressway

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
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First Class Mail

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